

A missed opening means an empty chair

Juniper's cancellation problem

Today, Lena and Carla find a cancellation in Square, search their Google Sheet, and text clients by hand.

Tracking replies slows the move to the next suitable client. Contacting several clients creates competing acceptances.

Lena's priority: automatic follow-up without double booking. Filling openings matters more than speed alone.

One eligible client at a time

The offer process

1. Staff enter today's opening: service, stylist, start time and duration.
2. Match service, recorded availability and required stylist. Offer to the oldest eligible waitlist request.
3. Hold the opening for 15 minutes. A decline or timeout moves to the next eligible client.
4. Acceptance confirms the demo booking and removes the request. Staff record the change in Square.

The system remembers what it is waiting for

Temporal keeps the process moving

Durable timers expire offers even when the browser is closed. Workflow history lets a restarted Worker recover its state.

One coordinating workflow owns reservations across openings. Each client and each opening can have only one active offer.

Expired, cancelled and duplicate acceptances cannot create a booking. Staff can stop outreach or mark an opening unavailable.

No new offers start with fewer than 15 minutes remaining before the appointment. Unfilled openings return to staff.

Real workflow, simulated communication

Prototype boundaries

Working locally: staff dashboard, private offer screen, matching, durable deadlines, acceptance and response history.

Simulated: sample waitlist and on-screen text messages. Demo speed uses 15 seconds instead of 15 minutes.

Excluded: live SMS, Square integration, production authentication and automatic rescheduling. Staff keep Square aligned manually.

Assumptions to confirm: cancelling an offer stops outreach; when all matching clients are busy, staff retry manually. Real delivery failure policy remains open.

A supervised pilot with Lena and Carla

A practical next step

First, rehearse acceptance, timeout, late replies and manual cancellation together using sample clients.

Before contacting real clients, agree the delivery failure policy and add authenticated access, SMS delivery and a reliable Square booking check.

Then pilot a small set of same-day openings. Track filled openings / eligible cancellations, staff follow-up time, and conflicting booking attempts.

Review the results with Lena before expanding. No business improvement has been measured yet.